Text 2: THE DIGITAL AGE

Computers have become an essential part of our lives. Young people who have grown up with PCs and mobile phones are often called *the digital generation.* Computers help students to **perform mathematical operations** and improve their maths skills. They are used to **access the Internet,** to **do** basic **research** and to communicate with other students around the world.

Teachers use projectors and interactive whiteboards to **give presentations** and teach sciences, history or language courses. PCs are also used for administrative purposes - schools use word processors to write letters, and databases to **keep records** of students and teachers. A school website allows teachers to publish exercises for students to complete online.

Students can also enrol for courses via the website and parents can download official reports. Mobiles let you make voice calls, send texts, email people and download logos, ringtones or games. With a built-in camera you can send pictures and make video calls in *face-to-face* mode. New smartphones combine a telephone with web access, video, a games console, an MP3 player, a personal digital assistant (PDA) and a GPS navigation system, all in one.

In banks, computers **store information** about the money held by each customer and enable staff to access large **databases** and to **carry out** financial **transactions** at high speed. They also control the cashpoints, or ATMs (automatic teller machines), which dispense money to customers by the use of a PIN-protected card. People use a Chip and PIN card to pay for goods and services. Instead of using a signature to **verify payments**, customers are asked to enter a four-digit personal identification number (PIN), the same number used at cashpoints; this system makes transactions more secure. With online banking, clients can easily **pay bills** and **transfer money** from the comfort of their homes.

Airline pilots use computers to help them control the plane. For example, monitors display data about fuel consumption and weather conditions.

In airport control towers, computers are used to **manage radar systems** and regulate air traffic. On the ground, airlines are connected to travel agencies by computer. Travel agents use computers to find out about the availability of lights, prices, times, stopovers and many other details.

REMEMBER

When you read a text, you will often see a new word that you don't recognize. If you can identify what type of word it is (noun, verb, adjective, etc.) it can help you guess the meaning.

1. Find the words (1-10) in the text above. Can you guess the meaning from context? Are they nouns, verbs, adjectives or adverbs? Write *n, v, adj* **or** *adv* **next to each word.**

1. perform .....
2. digital .....
3. word processor .....
4. store .....
5. online .....
6. financial .....
7. download .....
8. monitor .....
9. built-in .....
10. data .....

2. Match the words in (1-10) above with the correct meanings (a-j) below.

A. keep, save _____

B. execute, do _____

C. monetary _____

D. screen _____

E. integrated _____

F. connected to the Internet _____

G.Collection of facts or figures _____

H. describes information that is recorded or broadcast using computers _____

I. program used for text manipulation _____

J. copy files from a server to your PC or mobile _____

COLLOCATIONS. *What are they?*

A collocation is a natural combination of words that native speakers often use together. They "sound right" because they frequently appear side by side in everyday language. These word pairings become familiar through repeated use, and while they may follow grammatical rules, their real strength lies in sounding natural and fluent.

Collocations can be made up of different types of words—verbs with nouns, adjectives with nouns, or adverbs with verbs. Learning them helps you avoid awkward or unnatural phrasing and makes your English smoother, more confident, and more like that of a native speaker.

Some examples of collocations are:

- **Verb + noun**: *take a shower, have lunch. Do research, display data*
- **Adjective + noun**: *strong coffee, deep sleep*
- **Adverb + verb**: *deeply regret, strongly recommend*
- **Noun + noun**: *traffic jam, data analysis*

LET'S PRACTICE!

1. Match the verbs (1–5) with the nouns (a–e) to make collocations from the text "The digital age."

1. Give	**A.** money
2. Keep	**B.** a PIN
3. Access	**C.** databases
4. Enter	**D.** Presentations
5. Transfer	**E.** Records

1. Thanks to Wi-Fi, it's now easy to _____ from cafes, hotels, parks and many other public places.
2. Online banking lets you _____ between your accounts easily and securely.
3. Skype is a technology that enables users to _____ over the Internet for free.
4. In many universities, students are encouraged to _____ using PowerPoint in order to make their talks more visually attractive.

5. The Web has revolutionized the way people _____ with sites such as Google and Wikipedia; you can find the information you need in seconds.
6. Cookies allow a website to _____ on a user's machine and later retrieve it; when you visit the website again, it remembers your preferences.
7. With the latest mobile phones, you can _____ with multimedia attachments – pictures, audio, even video.